

CASE ID: 201908710255

EPISODE NAME: Travel Ban on German Human Rights Committee

2019/08/02 - 2019/09

Sender: China (710)

Target: Germany (255)

Issue: Contain Political Influence (1)

Final outcome: Stalemate after Sanctions Imposition (9)

Summary:

On 2019/08/04, Deutsche Welle reported that China had denied visas to the German Human Rights Committee.¹ The committee was planning to visit Xinjiang and assess the human rights afforded to China's Uyghur ethnic minority.

Narrative:

On 2019/08/04, Deutsche Welle reported that China had denied visas to the German Human Rights Committee.² The committee intended to travel to Beijing, Tibet and Xinjiang to focus on the treatment of minority groups in China. On 2019/08/02, China's ambassador to the United Nations Zhang Jun told reporters that Beijing would not allow interference in the country's "internal affairs, especially on issues related to Xinjiang, Tibet and Hong Kong."³

The episode ended in a stalemate in 2019/09 after the Human Rights committee did not take the trip, but simultaneously refused to moderate its position on China's treatment of minorities. Committee president Michael Brand said of the incident: "[This] is about making an example of people who dare to clearly address the topic of human rights and touch on sensitive issues."⁴

¹ Deutsche Welle. "China Denies Entry to German Greens Party – DW – 08/04/2019." *Deutsche Welle*, August 4th, 2019. www.dw.com/en/china-denies-entry-to-german-greens-party/a-49883911.

² Ibid.

³ Ibid.

⁴ Deutsche Welle. "China Denies Entry to German Greens Party – DW – 08/04/2019." *Deutsche Welle*, August 4th, 2019. www.dw.com/en/china-denies-entry-to-german-greens-party/a-49883911.